Gymshark Social Media Marketing Analytics

Hashen Rathnayake

List of figures

Figure 1: Instagram followers count Gymshark (left) vs Nike (Right) 5
Figure 2: X followers count Gymshark (left) vs Nike (Right)..... 6
Figure 3: Instagram total engagement (left) and Instagram engagement rate by followers (right) 8
Figure 4: Instagram engagement Nike vs Gymshark..... 8
Figure 5: Instagram highest engaged posts for both brands 9
Figure 6: X engagement Nike vs Gymshark..... 9
Figure 7: X total engagement (left) and X engagement rate by followers (right) 10
Figure 8: X highest engaged posts for both brands..... 10
Figure 9: Instagram post reach Gymshark (left) and Nike (right) 11
Figure 10: Instagram engagement Nike vs Gymshark..... 11
Figure 11: Instagram most reached post Gymshark (left) and Nike (right)..... 12
Figure 12: Instagram audience demographic - Gymshark..... 12
Figure 13: Instagram audience demographic - Nike..... 12
Figure 14: Follower net change Instagram (left) and X (right) 13
Figure 15: Gym tips content pillar in Instagram..... 13
Figure 16: Instagram advertisement types 14
Figure 17: Instagram advertisement demographic Gymshark (left) vs Nike (right) 14
Figure 18: Topic modelling 15
Figure 19: Sentiment analysis..... 15
Figure 20: Topic proportion over time..... 15

List of tables

Table 1: Social media audit table..... 7

Table of Contents

1. Introduction 4
2. Part 1: Social media marketing analytics 4
   2.1. Social Media Objectives 4
3. Social media activity analysis 5
   3.1. Social media audit 7
   3.2. Social media key metrics 8
      3.2.1. Engagement 8
      3.2.2. Reach and impressions 11
      3.2.3. Audience demographics and behaviour 12
      3.2.4. Advertisement performance 14
4. Data analysis 15
5. Social media intelligence 17
   5.1. SWOT analysis 17
      5.1.1. Strengths: 17
      5.1.2. Weakness: 17
      5.1.3. Opportunities: 17
      5.1.4. Threats: 17
6. Recommendations 18
   6.1. Product focused content 18
   6.2. Expand collaborations 18
   6.3. Increase global audience 18
   6.4. Encourage user-generated content 18
   6.5. Align content with key events 18
7. Conclusion 19

1. Introduction

In this report well-known two apparel brands are evaluated with Gymshark selected as the primary brand under scrutiny to analyse its social media presence, and Nike as its competitor for comparison. The key objectives covered under this part include marketing impact, electronic word-of-mouth which are measured using the following key performance indicators (KPIs): engagement, reach, sentiment, and audience behaviour. This section also aims to discuss the effectiveness of social media strategy, primarily on Instagram and X (Twitter) adopted by Gymshark to engage with its audience base and provides recommendations to achieve its marketing objectives.

2. Part 1: Social media marketing analytics

The purpose of this section is to analyse the current social media marketing presence of Gymshark and provide recommendations to achieve its marketing objectives. Nike has been selected as the competitor for comparison, as both have become major brands in the UK apparel market.

2.1.Social Media Objectives

To analyse the current social media marketing presence of Gymshark compared with Nike, four objectives were selected. These metrics commonly used to evaluate social media marketing performance.

2.1.1. Objective 1: Marketing impact

This objective aims to evaluate the effectiveness of social media in attracting an audience. KPIs for this objective are:

- Audience engagement
- Conversation reach

2.1.2. Objective 2: eWOM (Electronic word-of-mouth)

This objective aims to assess how customers share their opinions and promote the brand through social media, as eWOM provides organic user-generated content. KPIs for this objective are:

- Advocate influence
- Advocacy impact

2.1.3. Objective 3: Brand image

This objective aims to understand how social media activities influence the development of a positive brand image, focusing on whether is viewed positively or negatively. KPIs for this objective are:

- Sentiment ratio
- Topic trends

3. Social media activity analysis

Social media activity analysis reported in this study was conducted over a specified time frame, spanning from 07 February 2026 to 08 March 2026. social media platforms taken into consideration to assess the brand's online presence are Instagram and X (formerly known as Twitter), as these platforms are widely used by Gymshark and Nike to attract customers.

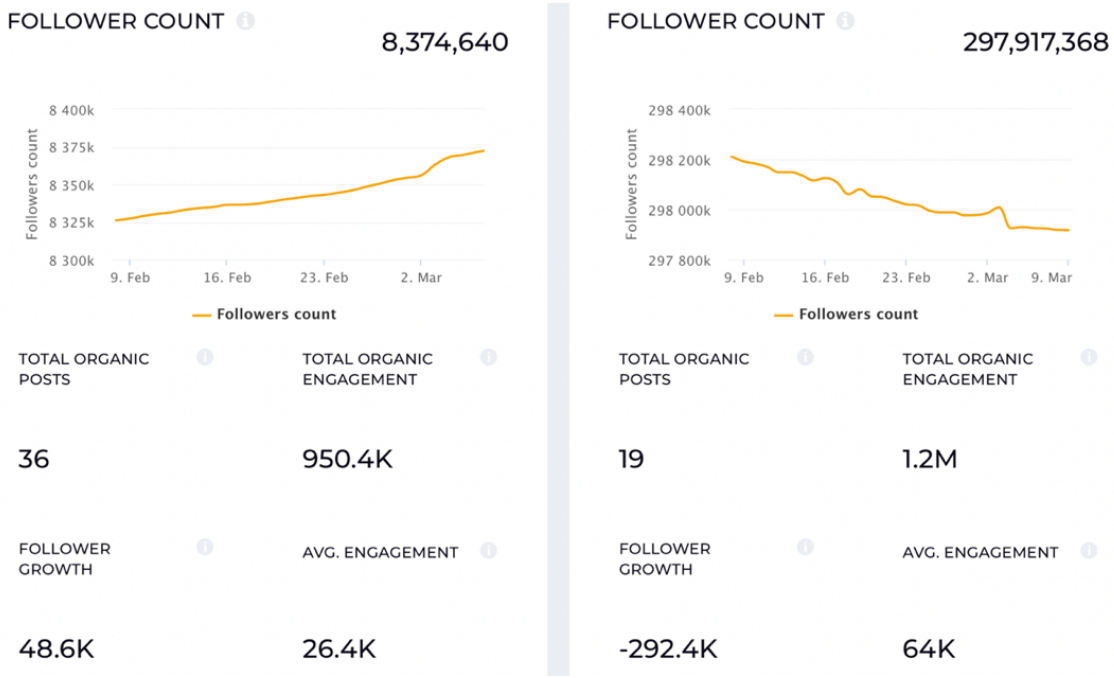


Figure 1: Instagram followers count Gymshark (left) vs Nike (Right)

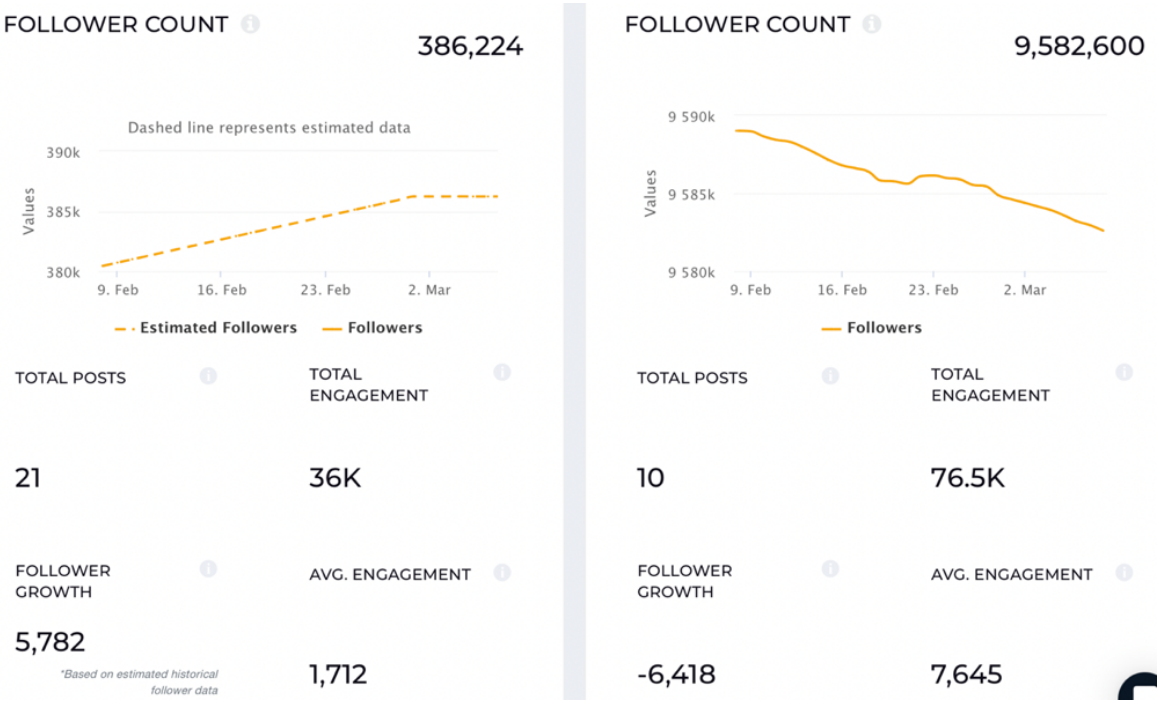


Figure 2: X followers count Gymshark (left) vs Nike (Right)

According to the *Figure 1,* Nike has a significantly higher follower count on Instagram (298 million) compared to Gymshark's 8.37 million followers. Despite its smaller follower base, Gymshark experienced positive follower growth of 46,000, whereas Nike exhibits a negative trend of 292,000 followers. During this period, Gymshark published 36 posts compared to Nike's 19 posts. A similar pattern is observed on X. *Figure 2* shows that Nike has a larger follower base (9.58 million) compared to Gymshark's 386,000 followers. Gymshark shows a positive follower growth, while Nike shows a negative growth trend. Although Nike has approximately 25 times more followers than Gymshark, it generates only slightly more than twice the level of engagement, suggesting that Gymshark achieves stronger engagement.

3.1.Social media audit

A social media audit was conducted to evaluate Gymshark's social media presence and performance on Instagram and X, in comparison with its competitor Nike.

Table 1: Social media audit table

Who	Where	What	When	Why	Opportunity
Gymshark	Instagram	• Sharing fitness-related photos and workout videos, • Influencer-led collaborations, • Product promotions	36 Posts per month	• Build a strong brand community, • Promote fitness-oriented lifestyles, • Product-focused promotional content	• High engagement with young fitness-oriented lifestyle to increase user-generated content • **Rating – 5**
	X	• Short form updates, • Brand announcements, • Customer interactions	21 Tweets per month	• Facilitate customer communication, • Provide timely brand updates	• Opportunity to engage through discussions, polls, and real time fitness content • **Rating – 3**
Nike	Instagram	• Professional athlete campaigns, • Product launches, • Brand-led storytelling content	19 Posts per month	• Strengthen brand identity, • Inspire athletes, • Promote new products offerings	• Opportunity to increase community interaction and encourage user-generated content from consumers • **Rating – 5**
	X	• Sports-related updates, • Campaign announcements, • Athlete collaborations, • Customer service interactions	10 Tweets per month	• Enable real-time communication, • Promote brand campaigns • Engagement during sports events	• Opportunity to increase conversational engagement and community interaction • **Rating – 4**

3.2.Social media key metrics

Key metrics in social media are used to evaluate the effectiveness of content in achieving marketing strategies. In this section, several key metrics are discussed, including engagement, reach and impressions, audience demographics and behaviour, and advertisement performance.

3.2.1. Engagement

- Instagram:

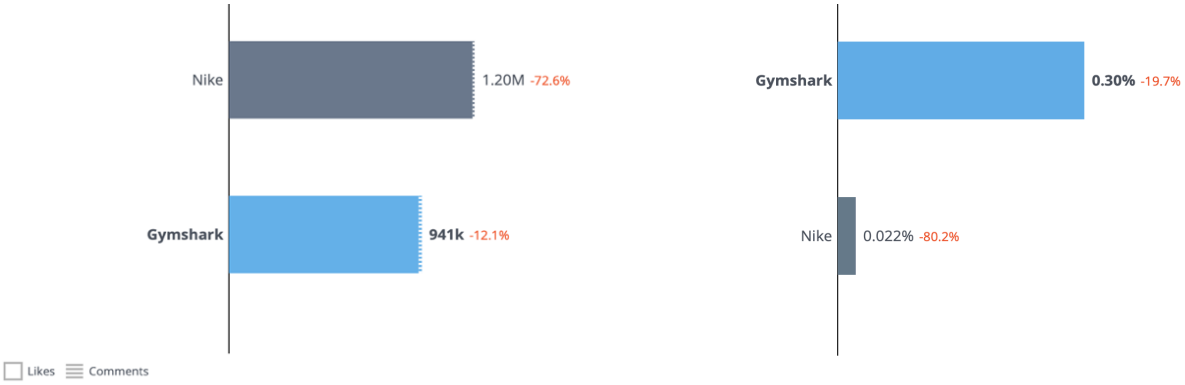


Figure 3: Instagram total engagement (left) and Instagram engagement rate by followers (right)

Gymshark has a significantly smaller follower base (8.37 million) compared to Nike's 298 million followers. As a result, its total Instagram engagement (942,014) is lower than Nike's (1.2 million) (*Figure 3*). However, Gymshark achieves a higher engagement rate (0.3%) compared to Nike's (0.02%).

PROFILE	FOLLOWERS	ENGAGEMENT	POSTS	AVG. ENGAGEMENT	COMMENTS	LIKES
nike	297,899,003	1,199,855	18	66.66K	9,247	1,190,608
gymshark	8,373,687	942,014	37	25.46K	14,803	927,211

Figure 4: Instagram engagement Nike vs Gymshark

According to *Figure 4*, Gymshark's followers demonstrated higher engagement through comments (14,803) compared to Nike (9,247). Comments account for 1.57% of Gymshark's total engagement, whereas Nike records only 0.77%, indicating that Gymshark generate approximately

twice the level of comment-based interaction. This suggests that users are more actively engaged in discussions and interactions with Gymshark, despite its smaller follower base.

Published At	Post		Eng. Total	Likes	Comments	Eng. Rate by Follower	Eng. Rate Lift	Post Type
Feb. 9, 2026 11:00 AM GMT	Carou...	Nike Nike Atelier for Jannik Sinner is taking ACG to new heights. Nike Atelier is the best of Nike, crafted to the exact specifications of the greatest... View on Instagram		223k	222k	1.34k	0.075%	+2.09x	Carousel
Mar. 7, 2026 2:03 AM GMT	Carou...	Gymshark Earned the moment. Built for more. 📸: brandonseye View on Instagram		202k	202k	469	2.41%	+70.5x	Carousel
Feb. 19, 2026 11:46 PM GMT	Carou...	Nike She wore gold for a reason. alysaxliu wins Gold in Figure Skating, the first for the United States in 24 years. #MilanoCortina2026 #Olympics View on Instagram		187k	186k	545	0.063%	+1.72x	Carousel
Feb. 9, 2026 7:06 PM GMT	Carou...	Nike When you're this fast, you don't ask for permission. juttaleerdam breaks the Olymp ic record in the Speed Skating 1000M and wins her first Gold... View on Instagram		167k	166k	820	0.056%	+1.53x	Carousel

Figure 5: Instagram highest engaged posts for both brands

An overview of the four most engaged posts across both brands on Instagram (*Figure 5*) indicates that, the highest engagement (223,000) was achieved by a Nike post promoting its ACG apparel line featuring professional tennis player Jannik Sinner. The second most engaged post features Brandon Seye, a Gymshark athlete, targeting fitness and bodybuilding audiences. Although it ranked second in total engagement, it records the highest engagement rate (2.41%), indicating strong interaction within Gymshark community. The third and fourth most engaged posts focus on Olympic athletes, including Alysa Liu and Jutta Leerdam, linking Nike to major sports achievements. During the selected time period, Nike's content heavily focused on Olympic-related themes, which attracted significant audience attention.

- X (Twitter):

PROFILE	FOLLOWERS	ENGAGEMENT	POSTS	AVG. ENGAGEMENT	LIKES	REPLIES	QUOTES	RETWEETS
Nike	9,582,659	76,458	10	7,646	65,792	1,616	666	8,384
Gymshark	386,236	37,347	22	1,698	32,016	465	216	4,650

Figure 6: X engagement Nike vs Gymshark

According to *Figure 6,* Gymshark has a lower follower base on X (386,236) compared to Nike's 9.58 million followers. As a result, Nike achieves a higher average engagement per post (7,646) compared to Gymshark (1,698). However, *Figure 7* highlights that Gymshark has a higher engagement rate per followers (0.44%) than Nike (0.08%).

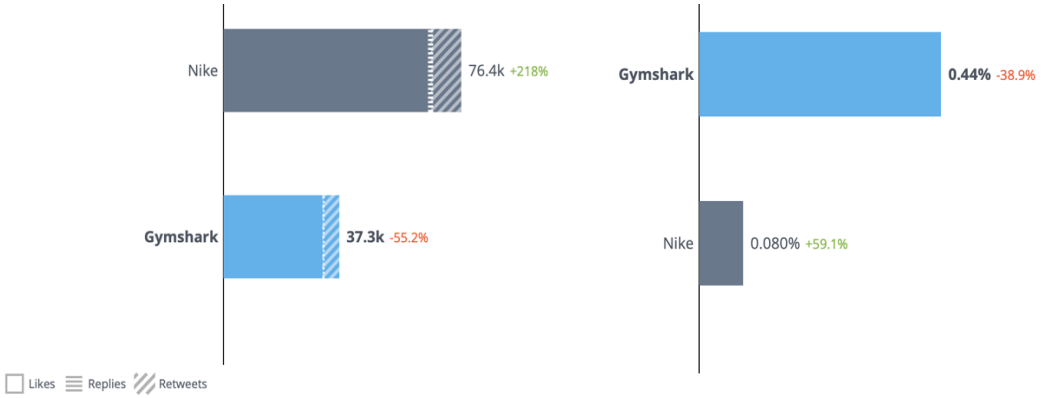


Figure 7: X total engagement (left) and X engagement rate by followers (right)

An overview of four most engaged posts across both brands on X (*Figure 8*) indicates that the highest engagement (29,900) was achieved by a Nike post promoting Alysa Liu's Olympic achievement. The second most engaged post features Marshawn Lynch, a former NFL player, targeting Super Bowl audiences. Interestingly, the third most engaged post focuses on gym motivation and, despite generating less than half of the total engagement, it records the highest engagement rate lift (+30.7 times), indicating strong interaction within Gymshark's fitness audience.

Published At	Tweet		Eng. Total	Likes	Retweets	Replies	Eng. Rate by Follower	Eng. Rate Lift	Imp.
Feb. 19, 2026 11:50 PM GMT	Photo	Nike She wore gold for a reason. Alysa Liu wins Gold in Figure Skating, the first for the United States in 24 years. #MilanoCortina2026 #Olympics pic.x.com... View on Twitter		29.9k	28.0k	1.83k	105	0.31%	+3.53x	1.77M
Feb. 9, 2026 3:27 AM GMT	Video	Nike Sweet sweet victory. pic.x.com/3FfOaknWYC View on Twitter		27.0k	21.3k	5.56k	141	0.28%	+3.08x	2.29M
Feb. 20, 2026 4:00 PM GMT	Photo	Gymshark pic.x.com/4cF1GCO6yk View on Twitter		11.6k	10.1k	1.50k	44	3.01%	+30.7x	162k
Feb. 8, 2026 9:48 PM GMT	Photo	Nike The Rebel of Skating returns. Alysa Liu and Team USA secure Gold in the Team Event for figure skating. #MilanoCortina2026 #Olympics pic.x.com/DDaD... View on Twitter		6.86k	6.20k	637	22	0.072%	-1.58x	143k

Figure 8: X highest engaged posts for both brands

3.2.2. Reach and impressions

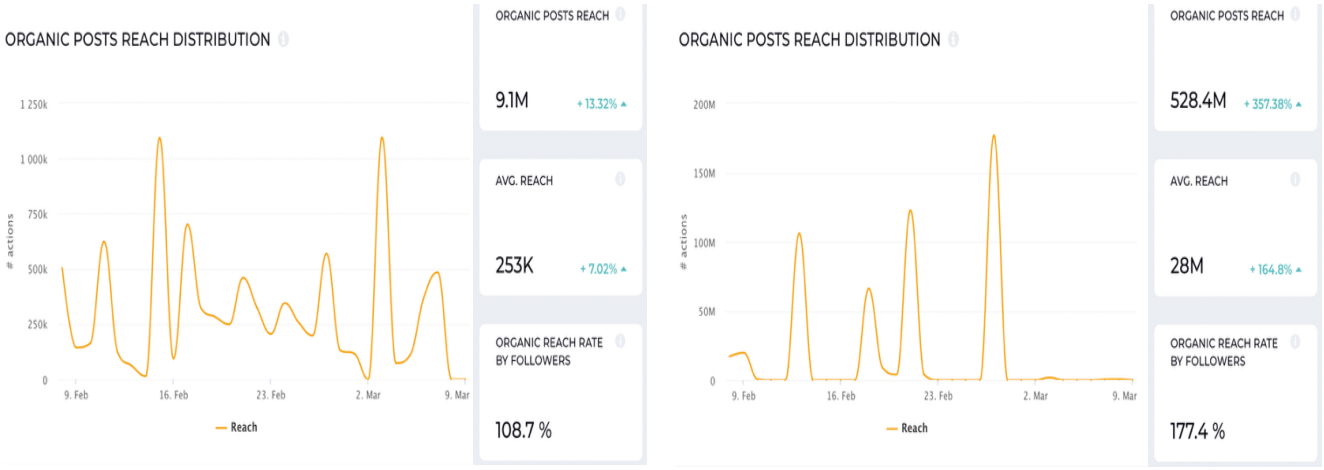


Figure 9: Instagram post reach Gymshark (left) and Nike (right)

Gymshark's Instagram posts reach approximately 9.1 million users, which is significantly lower than Nike's 528.4 million users (*Figure 9*). This difference is primarily due to Nike's larger follower base (298 million) compared to Gymshark's 8.3 million followers. As a result, Nike also generates significantly higher impressions, with over 1.6 billion organic views, whereas Gymshark records approximately 20 million views (*Figure 10*).

PROFILE	FOLLOWERS	ENGAGEMENT	POSTS	AVG. ENG. RATE BY REACH	POST REACH	ORGANIC POSTS VIEWS
nike	297,897,969	1,200,071	18	1.79%	527,803,497	1,612,000,058
gymshark	8,373,687	942,014	37	10.84%	9,300,039	20,045,897

Figure 10: Instagram engagement Nike vs Gymshark

An overview of the most reached posts for both brands on Instagram shows that Nike's most reached post achieved more than 20 times the reach of Gymshark's most reached post. However, Gymshark demonstrates higher engagement rates by followers, reach and views. This suggests that despite its smaller audience, Gymshark's followers are more actively engaged with the brand's content.

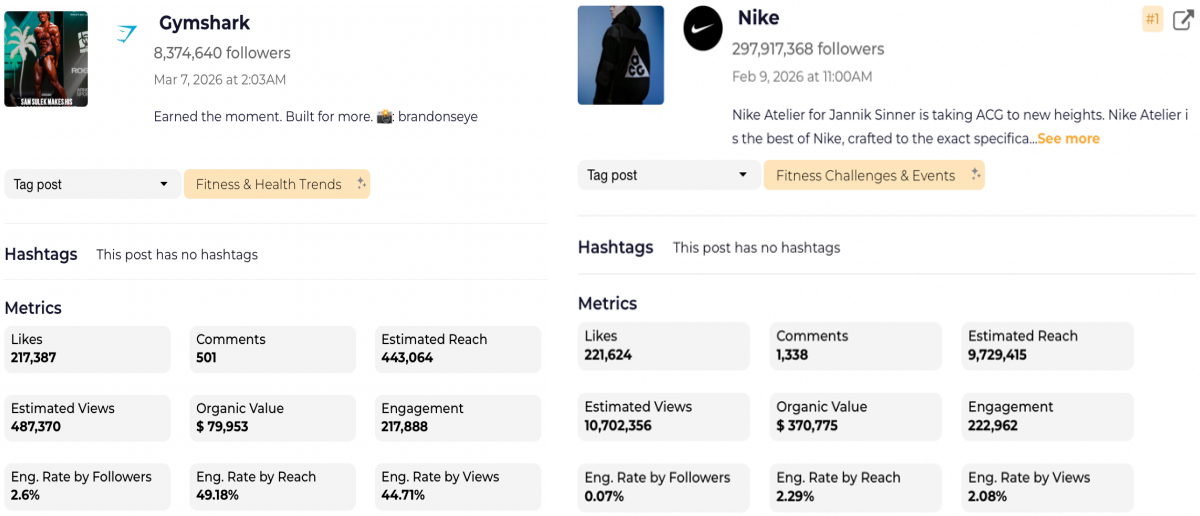


Figure 11: Instagram most reached post Gymshark (left) and Nike (right)

3.2.3. Audience demographics and behaviour

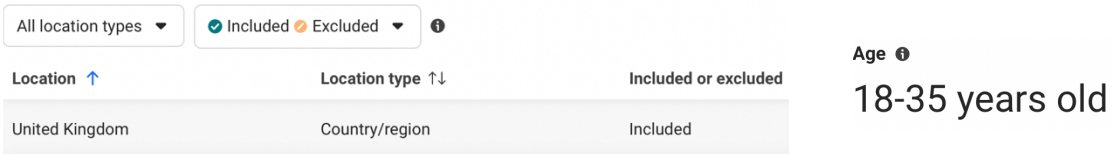


Figure 12: Instagram audience demographic - Gymshark

Gymshark's audience demographic is primarily based in the United Kingdom, with a target age group of 18-35 years (*Figure 12*). In contrast, Nike targets a broader European audience and caters to a wider age range of 18-65 years (*Figure 13*).

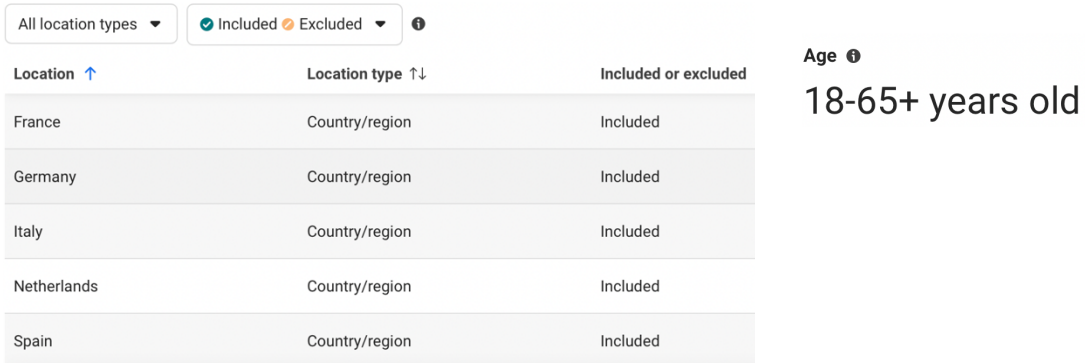


Figure 13: Instagram audience demographic - Nike

Considering the audience behaviour, *Figure 14* shows that Gymshark experienced positive audience growth across both Instagram and X, with increases of approximately 50,800 and 107 followers, respectively. In contrast, Nike recorded a decline of approximately 331,000 followers on Instagram and 6,790 in X. This suggests that Gymshark maintains a more effective strategy for sustaining audience engagement and growth.

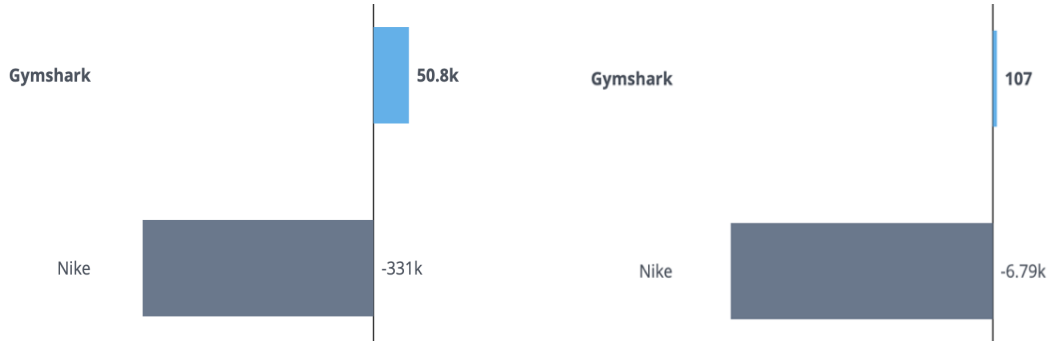


Figure 14: Follower net change Instagram (left) and X (right)

Nike achieves a higher total engagement (35,940) and reach (1.24 million) in the gym tips and advice content pillar on Instagram. However, despite reaching a smaller audience (119,090), Gymshark records a significantly higher average engagement rate (15.56%) compared to Nike's 2.89%. This indicates that although Nike benefits from greater global reach, Gymshark fosters a more interactive and community-driven audience.

PROFILES IN CONTENT PILLAR - GYM TIPS & ADVICE

Detailed information about each profile that was part of the content pillar.

NAME	FOLLOWERS	ENGAGEMENT	REACH	POSTS	AVG. ENG. RATE BY REACH	AVG. ENGAGEMENT
gymshark	8.37M	18.53K	119.09K	1	15.56 %	18.53K
nike	297.9M	35.94K	1.24M	1	2.89 %	35.94K

Figure 15: Gym tips content pillar in Instagram

3.2.4. Advertisement performance

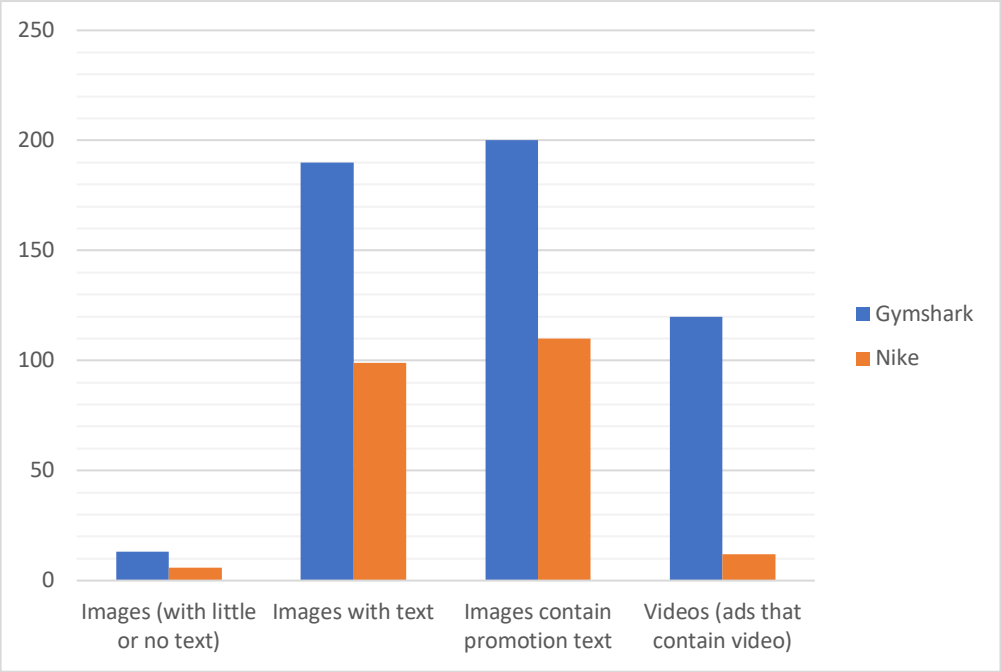


Figure 16: Instagram advertisement types

The advertisements were analysed for the period 07/02/2026 to 08/03/2026, during which Gymshark published approximately 523 Instagram advertisements compared to Nike's 227. *Figure 16* shows that Gymshark published more advertainments than Nike in every advertisement type. Both brands primarily use image-based advertisements, however, Gymshark uses this type approximately twice as often as Nike. In contrast, Nike follows more selective advertisement approach with fewer but potentially more targeted campaigns. Gymshark relies heavily on image and text-based advertisements, reflecting its community-oriented social media strategy.

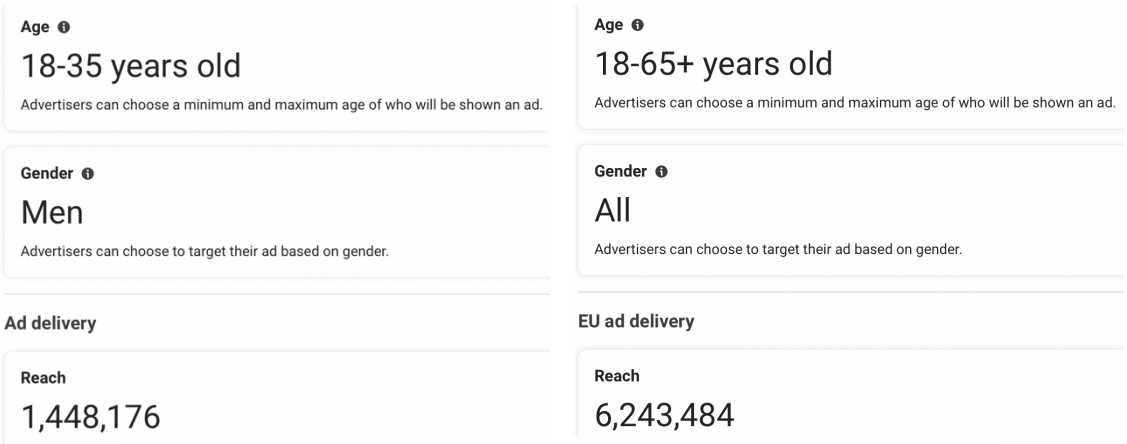


Figure 17: Instagram advertisement demographic Gymshark (left) vs Nike (right)

4. Data analysis

A topic modelling approach was used to identify key themes and understand what customer discuss about the brand by analysing comments on Gymshark's Instagram posts. Four main topic were identified, and themes were assigned as shown in *Figure 18*, based on the most frequent words within each topic.

Topic 1: short, □□, excus, habit, jacket, decis, pink, one, consist, got, just, b back, like, excit, show, line, get, need, set, come	**Topic 1: Product fit**
Topic 2: love, collect, wow, wait, look, □□□, amaz, best, see, yes, icon, consist, llike, just, good, need, communiti, sam, excit, excus	**Topic 2: Positive feedback**
Topic 3: gym, back, alreadi, thing, will, fit, want, time, communiti, get, come, one, just, short, wait, consist, love, decis, wow, like	**Topic 3: Gym lifestyle**
Topic 4: need, just, sam, got, like, drop, actual, anoth, els, regard, someon, still, sulek, set, good, line, show, excit, look, come	**Topic 4: Product demand**

Figure 18: Topic modelling

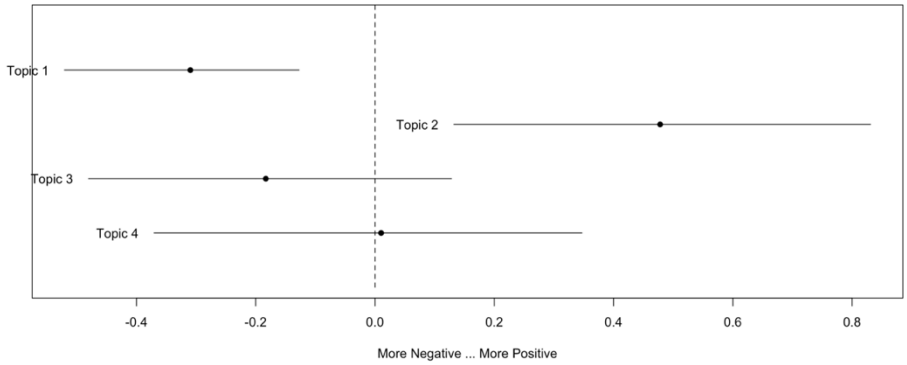


Figure 19: Sentiment analysis

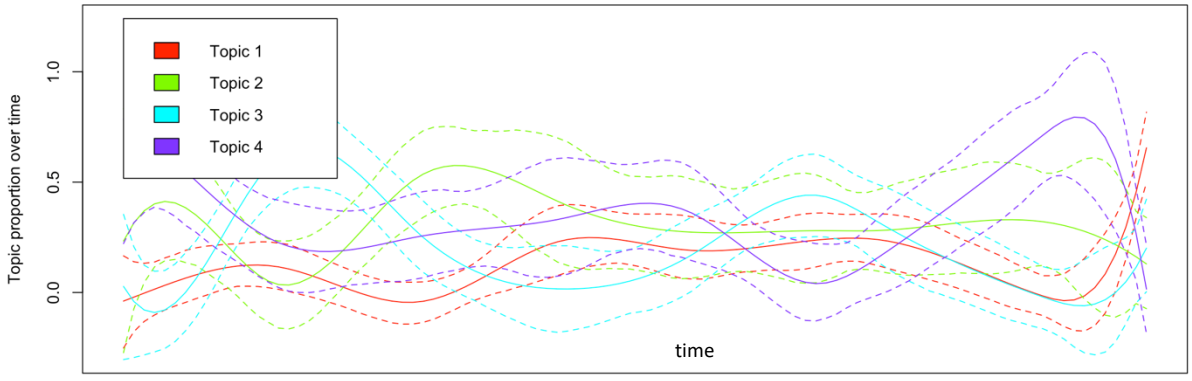


Figure 20: Topic proportion over time

Based on the selected objectives, key metrics were evaluated using topic modelling results alongside Gymshark's Instagram data.

For objective 1: Marketing impact, Topic 4 (product demand) was the most frequently mentioned theme in customer comments. However, it fluctuates over time and this suggests that product demand is influenced by time specific events such as promotions or product launches which drives more conversations. This further supported by *Figure 3*, where Gymshark records a higher engagement rate (0.3%) compared to Nike (0.02%).

For objective 2: eWOM, *Figure 19* shows that Topic 2 (positive feedback) has the highest positive sentiment, indicating that customers frequently express their satisfaction and share positive experiences. This reflects strong organic promotion and eWOM effects. This further supported by *Figure 9,* which indicates a high organic reach (108.7% by followers), while *Figure 4*, shows that Gymshark generates nearly twice as many comments as Nike despite having a smaller follower base.

For objective 3: Brand image, *Figure 19* indicates that overall sentiment is predominantly positive. However, Topic 1 (product fit) and Topic 3 (gym lifestyle) show slightly negative sentiment, suggesting areas for improvement. Topic 2 (positive feedback) has the highest positive sentiment and Topic 4 (product demand) shows slightly positive but neutral sentiment. Topic 2 and Topic 4 are the most influential themes shaping brand perception.

Overall, these findings suggest that Gymshark's social media performance is driven by positive user feedback, which strengthens brand image and supports eWOM. Furthermore, content related to product demand plays a major role in increasing audience engagement and building conversations.

5. Social media intelligence

5.1.SWOT analysis

5.1.1. Strengths:

Gymshark has a smaller follower base than Nike across both Instagram and Nike, however, it achieves a higher engagement rate on both platforms. Particularly on Instagram, Gymshark generates a higher number of comments during the selected period, indicating strong user interaction with the brand, and this will create long term consumer relationships. Moreover, this interaction is predominantly positive, as supported by sentiment analysis and eWOM findings. Gymshark not only promotes its product but also motivates users to engage in fitness activities, directly targeting a niche audience of fitness and gym enthusiasts. In addition, the brand demonstrates strong organic follower growth compared to Nike's decline.

5.1.2. Weakness:

Despite achieving a higher engagement rate per follower, Gymshark has significantly lower reach and impressions compared to Nike due to its smaller follower size. There is also an over usage on image-based advertisements which limits content variety. Furthermore, its audience is primarily concentrated in the United Kingdom and within the 18-35 age group, whereas Nike targets a broader European audience and a wider age range (18-65+), limiting Gymshark's market reach.

5.1.3. Opportunities:

With the advantage of strong positive feedback (Topic 2), Gymshark can further expand eWOM and strengthen its organic reach. To reduce the negative sentiment, the brand should increase product related content that highlights fit and quality. Additionally, collaborating with well-known athletes, similar to Nike's strategy during major events such as the Olympics, could enhance visibility and reach. Diversifying content and targeting more global audience would also support further growth.

5.1.4. Threats:

Gymshark faces strong competition from Nike, which has a significantly larger follower base, greater reach, and established global presence. Gymshark has a strong community interaction, it also increases the risk of negative discussions, particularly regarding product issues.

6. Recommendations

6.1.Product focused content

Topic modelling results indicate that product fit and quality are associated with negative sentiment. Therefore, Gymshark should create more content focused on product reviews, sizing guidance, and authentic customer feedback. This may include product comparison posts, user try-on and reviewing contents, which would enhance transparency and strengthen customer trust.

6.2.Expand collaborations

Gymshark already collaborates with influencers to market their brand effectively. However, compared to Nike's collaborations with globally recognised athletes, there is an opportunity to expand partnerships with well-known fitness personalities and athletes. This would increase brand visibility and enable access to new audience segments.

6.3.Increase global audience

Gymshark's audience mainly based in the UK and within the18-35 age group. Therefore, there is an opportunity to develop more diverse and inclusive content targeting wider age groups and international markets. This could be achieved through region specific campaigns and culturally relevant fitness content, supporting global expansion.

6.4.Encourage user-generated content

Gymshark already demonstrates strong community engagement supported by positive feedback. To further enhance this, the brand should encourage user-generated content through fitness challenges, reposting customer content and active participation within the fitness community. This approach would increase organic reach and strengthen eWOM.

6.5.Align content with key events

Nike successfully market their product through major sporting events, such as the Olympics, to increase engagement. Similarly, Gymshark should align its content strategy with seasonal trends and fitness events to maximise audience engagement.

7. Conclusion

This report analysed the social media marketing performance of Gymshark and the web marketing performance of the Google Merchandise Store. The findings highlight that, even with a smaller follower base than Nike, Gymshark generates higher engagement rates and higher levels of community interaction. This indicates that Gymshark has built a highly engaged and loyal audience through its marketing strategies. However, several limitations were identified, including lower reach, reliance on image-based content and limited demographic insights and recommendations are provided,

Overall, this report aims to provide a clear understanding of how user engagement with the brand can be improved by using social media analytics and offers recommendations to achieve the brand's marketing objectives.